WEIGHT 05

Bupropion

Antidepressant of the aminoketone class; for weight, approved only combined with naltrexone



CLASS Antidepressant (aminoketone)

STUDIED FOR Depression, smoking, weight

HUMAN EVIDENCE Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS FDA approved (Wellbutrin); weight: Contrave

STUDIED FOR

Depression	Quitting smoking	Body weight
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Weight use alone is off-label. For weight, FDA approved bupropion only combined with naltrexone, as Contrave (2014).

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Bupropion → Reuptake block → NE and dopamine → Mood, appetite

- **Label:** mechanism unknown; presumed noradrenergic and/or dopaminergic
- **Relatively weak** blocker of noradrenaline and dopamine reuptake
- **Does not** block serotonin reuptake or inhibit monoamine oxidase
- **With naltrexone,** lab and animal data point to appetite and reward areas

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Alone for weight: RCTs of 327 and 384 adults
- Contrave: 4 COR trials, 4,536 adults, 56 weeks
- Approved for depression since 1985

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Contrave heart safety, long term

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE About 21 hours (Wellbutrin XL label)

ROUTES STUDIED By mouth (tablets)

PHARMACOKINETICS Peak about 5 hours (XL); liver metabolism, mainly CYP2B6

SOLD AS Prescription tablets (Wellbutrin SR/XL; Contrave)

MONITORED IN TRIALS Mood and suicidal thoughts, blood pressure

SPORT (WADA) Not prohibited; 2026 Monitoring Program

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved: depression, smoking; weight via Contrave
FDA	Boxed warning: suicidal thoughts
DEA	Not a controlled substance
WADA	Monitored, not prohibited

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Wellbutrin XL prescribing information, Feb 2026
2. FDA, Contrave prescribing information, Nov 2025
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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